

3.4.2 Principles of food safety

Note: All temperatures and guidance in accordance with current Food Standards Agency (FSA) guidelines.

3.4.2.1 Buying and storing food

Content	Students must know and understand	Suggested application and food preparation skills
The food safety principles when buying and storing food.	• temperature control: • freezing: -18°C • chilling: 0 to below 5°C • danger zone: 5 to 63°C • cooking: 75°C • reheating: 75°C • ambient storage • temperature danger zone • correct use of domestic fridges and freezers • date marks • 'best before' and 'use by' dates • covering foods.	To apply food safety considerations when preparing, storing and cooking.

3.4.2.2 Preparing, cooking and serving food

Content	Students must know and understand	Suggested application and food preparation skills
The food safety principles when preparing, cooking and serving food.	• personal hygiene • clean work surfaces • separate raw and cooked foods and use of separate utensils • correct cooking times • appropriate temperature control including: defrosting and reheating • appropriate care with high risk foods • correct use of food temperature probes.	• Knife skills: preventing cross-contamination (S2). • Washing and drying vegetables during preparation to prevent food poisoning (S3). • Using a blender to make fruit coulis as a decoration, focusing on good hygienic practice, washing and drying fruit and ensuring cleanliness of equipment (S5). • Preparing, combining and shaping, for example wet mixtures (such as falafels, fish cakes or meatballs) whilst demonstrating technical skills of preventing cross contamination and handling high risk foods correctly (S7). • General practical skills – test for readiness. Use a temperature probe, knife/skewer, finger or ‘poke’ test, ‘bite’, visual colour check or sound to establish whether an ingredient or recipe is ready, to ensure the food is safe to eat (S1).